

Course information

Miriam Hurtado Bodell

Course instructors

Måns Magnusson, Associate Professor in Statistics, Uppsala University:
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Miriam Hurtado Bodell, Post Doc in Analytical Sociology, Linköping University: miriam.hurtado.bodell@liu.se

Guest lectures by: Väinö Yrjänäinen, and Marcel Bollmann

Course structure

5 lectures

4 literature seminars

4 lab sessions

1 day of project presentations

Lectures

Each lecture day $\sim$ 3 hours. 2 hours technical introduction, 1 hour social science approaches

Monday 6/8. Introduction: text as data

Tuesday 6/9. Topic models

Thursday 6/11. Word embeddings

Monday 6/15. Transformers/Encoders

Wednesday 6/17. Large Language Models/Decoders

Literature seminars

Each seminar is ~ 2 hours. I will circulate a list that matches students with articles, the student will prepare a ~ 10 -minute presentation about the paper (focus: what is your main social scientific take-away? + discussion questions).

The goal is that the presentation can work as the starting point for discussions, be transparent with what was difficult to understand etc.

Presentation is followed by ~ 10 -15 minutes discussion among the students. Måns and I will also be there to give our perspectives.

Literature seminars

2	Udochi Great Uchechukwu	Topic Models	Roberts et al. (2014) – <i>Structural topic models for open-ended survey responses</i>
3	Lu Yan	Topic Models	DiMaggio, Nag & Blei (2013) – <i>Exploiting affinities between topic modeling and the sociological perspective on culture</i>
4	Aini Hadi	Topic Models	Hurtado Bodell, Magnusson & Keuschnigg (2026) – <i>Seeded topic models in digital archives</i>
5	Carlos Regino Villalobos Espinosa	Word Embeddings	Kozlowski, Taddy & Evans (2019) – <i>The geometry of culture</i>
6	Clara Englert	Word Embeddings	Stoltz & Taylor (2021) – <i>Cultural cartography with word embeddings</i>
7	Landry Botokou	Word Embeddings	Kozlowski, Taddy & Evans (2019) – <i>The geometry of culture</i>
8	Bulin Li	Word Embeddings	Best & Arseniev-Koehler (2023) – <i>The stigma of diseases: Unequal burden, uneven decline</i>
9	Milos Milovanovic	Transformers / Encoders	Bonikowski, Luo & Stuhler (2022) – <i>Politics as usual? Measuring populism, nationalism, and authoritarianism in US presidential campaigns</i>
10	Eric D. A. Ngo	Transformers / Encoders	Bonikowski, Luo & Stuhler (2022) – <i>Politics as usual? Measuring populism, nationalism, and authoritarianism in US presidential campaigns</i>
11	aalk1@st-andrews.ac.uk	Transformers / Encoders	Do, Ollion & Shen (2022) – <i>The augmented social scientist</i>
12	Yunting Xie	Transformers / Encoders	Do, Ollion & Shen (2022) – <i>The augmented social scientist</i>
13	Jasper Darin	LLMs / Decoders	Than et al. (2025) – <i>Updating “the future of coding”: Qualitative coding with generative large language models</i>
14	Florencia Piñeyrua	LLMs / Decoders	Stuhler, Ton & Ollion (2025) – <i>From Codebooks to Promptbooks</i>

In-person lab sessions (voluntary)

Hendrik Erz will be the RA holding the in-person labs. You can choose to do the labs at home if you want.

Labs available at GitHub:

https://github.com/IAS-LiU/SIRCSS-CTA_2026

Lab reports are handed to Hendrik: hendrik.erz@liu.se

Examination

You decide how many credits you want, maximum 6 ECTS.

3 ECTS:

- Participate in the lectures
- Take part in the literature seminars (including a brief presentation on one of the assigned readings)
- Submit three completed laboratory reports

6 ECTS:

- Fulfill criteria for 3 ECTS
- Complete an extended abstract or paper draft (2–4 pages)
- Present their paper projects during the second week

Paper project

Make it relevant for your own research! Should contain:

- A clearly formulated research question;
- A convincing conceptual framework anchored in the relevant literature;
- An account of the data sources or data collection strategy;
- A description of the measurement strategy and methods of analysis, including the strengths and weaknesses of the research design;
- And, if applicable, the results of the analysis and a discussion of the outcome.

Let's get started!

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